Someone here is an impostor

COUNT ACTIVE PLAYERS

The Keeper is outside the player count, cannot be accused, receives no role, never votes and does not win with either side. For 4/5/6/7/8 active players use respectively 3/4/5/6/7 residents and always exactly one impostor.

PREPARE A FAIR DECK

Each scenario role sheet has seven resident cards and one impostor card. For fewer than eight players, remove the extra residents before shuffling. The Keeper may see the printed memory because the Keeper is not an active player. Do not prepare a deck consisting only of residents.

REMEMBER

Residents privately read the same location, object and memory. The impostor reads only bluffing instructions. Everyone hears the public setup, but the Keeper never reads the secret memory or keywords aloud.

INVESTIGATE

Play three discussion rounds. Each active player gets a turn each round. There are two warrants for the whole game. At most one may be used before the end of round three; keep the other for the final council.

PROTECT THE SECRET

Residents must not knowingly contradict the printed memory. Nobody may say, spell, translate, write or encode a protected keyword, its object plural or listed alternate form outside a verified formal guess. Keep cards private. If one keyword leaks, continue; if both leak outside a formal guess, cancel with no winner. No player is eliminated.

Review v0.1. First playable, not yet independently tested. Full rules and edge cases are in the main kit.

Two warrants. One final guess.

ROUNDS

Round 1: everyone answers the opening question. Round 2: everyone responds to the shared task. Round 3: everyone asks another player one question. Discuss after each sweep. Everyone keeps playing.

EARLY COUNCIL

After round 1 or 2, a strict majority of all active players can approve the one optional early secret vote. It uses one warrant. Reserve the other until round 3 ends. No approved early vote means both warrants remain for final council.

BALLOTS

Write one eligible seat number or PASS; reveal simultaneously. Required votes: 3/4 players, 3/5, 4/6, 4/7, 5/8. Self-votes allowed. PASS and invalid ballots lower no threshold. A vote always spends one warrant. No majority means no check or tiebreak.

CHECKS AND FINAL COUNCIL

Keeper privately checks the accused. A resident remains active and voting but cannot be accused again. At final council resolve all remaining warrants, allowing up to one minute between the two if both remain. No capture after all warrants means impostor wins.

THE GUESS

A captured impostor makes one exact location/object guess before any secret is revealed. Both accepted forms correct: impostor wins. Either wrong or no pair: residents win. The impostor may instead voluntarily declare a formal guess before ballots open, privately verify their role to the Keeper, then give the pair; the same correct/wrong rule ends the game immediately. No extra guess follows.

SPOILERS AHEAD

The next page is the Keeper's secret key for scenario 01. Active players stop here. The final page has role cards: deal one impostor plus N-1 residents, after removing unused residents and shuffling.

Lanterns After Dark

PRIVATE KEEPER PAGE / ACTIVE PLAYERS STOP HERE

Read only the PUBLIC SETUP, OPENING QUESTION and TOWN TASK aloud. Keep the pair, memory and acceptance list private.

PUBLIC SETUP

The town lights failed during the annual lantern parade. Everyone remembers helping, but one account belongs to a stranger.

OPENING QUESTION / ROUND ONE

Which detail would you notice before touching anything?

TOWN TASK / ROUND TWO

Describe a useful precaution without naming either secret.

SECRET PAIR

ARCHIVE + COMPASS

SHARED RESIDENT MEMORY

You all met in the archive, where a brass compass was used to orient the old parade map. A window rattled as the lights went out.

ACCEPTED FORMAL-GUESS FORMS

Place: ARCHIVE. Object: COMPASS, COMPASSES. No other synonyms or translations.

KEEPER NOTE

Keep discussion about the remembered meeting, not how a compass works.

Next page: seven resident cards and one impostor card. Use exactly one impostor and N-1 residents for N active players. Remove the unused residents before shuffling.

Private roles / 01

SCENARIO 01 / PRIVATE

RESIDENT

ARCHIVE + COMPASS
You all met in the archive, where a brass compass was used to orient the old parade map. A window rattled as the lights went out.
Keep this memory covered during checks.

SCENARIO 01 / PRIVATE

RESIDENT

ARCHIVE + COMPASS
You all met in the archive, where a brass compass was used to orient the old parade map. A window rattled as the lights went out.
Keep this memory covered during checks.

SCENARIO 01 / PRIVATE

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SCENARIO 01 / PRIVATE

RESIDENT

ARCHIVE + COMPASS
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Keep this memory covered during checks.

SCENARIO 01 / PRIVATE

IMPOSTOR

You did not receive the shared memory. Use the public setup and conversation to bluff. Exactly one impostor exists. If caught, give one exact location/object pair before the memory is revealed. Both correct wins; either wrong loses.